

Strengthening Your Resume

The purpose of your resume is to articulate the value that you bring to an organization. It can also open the door to an interview.

4 Principles to Improve Content:

1. Focus on the needs of your audience – Learn what is important to the reader, and be sure to include examples of your work that will demonstrate that you have the experience that they require. Scan your resume for jargon that would not be related to your target industry. Review function specific resumes.
2. Prioritize your most important message first – Review your resume to ensure your bullets and actions are in the order of impact and importance. Review examples of strongly worded bullet points.
3. Be specific about the actions you took, use powerful action verbs – Fold your resume in half lengthwise. Look at the first word in each bullet to make sure it is strong and action oriented. Avoid repeating the same words.
4. Highlight the impact of your work – Review each role and look for quantitative results, such as saved \$, increased profits, improved effectiveness by X%, and qualitative impact such as launching a new product, or creating a best practice.

Recommendations:

- Don't let your format get in the way of the content. See the Chicago-style resume template. A one-page resume is standard; a two-page resume is acceptable for more than 10 years of experience.
- Perform an inventory of your experiences and accomplishments to identify examples of your unique value.
- Review the Booth Resume Database Archive in GTS to see examples of how other students positioned their experience.
- Upload your final resume to GTS and the Resume Database for Alumni and Part-time Students (RAPS).
- Update your LinkedIn profile to ensure your online message is consistent with, but not the same as, your new resume.

Resources:

Online:

- Alumni = Career Services > Changing Companies, Functions, and Industries > Resumes and Cover Letters
- E/W = Careers > Market & Prepare Yourself > Write a Resume

Books (Fisher Career Resource Center):

- *How to Say It on Your Resume* – Brad Karsh
- *No-Nonsense Resumes* – Wendy Enelow and Arnold G. Boldt

- *Packaging Yourself: The Targeted Resume* – Kate Wendleton

CareerCast (<https://www.chicagobooth.edu/careercast>)

- *The Career Story That Commands Attention* – Joe McCormack
- *The Compelling Personal Brand* – Michael Hyatt
- *Your Career Story: Communicating to Influence* – Ben Decker

Other

- Questions? Contact Career Services by email at boothworks@ChicagoBooth.edu or by calling 312-464-8677.